as the factory of the world and India's opening up of its economy led to a spectacular growth in bilateral trade during the 2000s. China became India's largest trading partner in goods in 2008, and bilateral trade reached a peak of US$74.412 billion in 2011.[84] Even as Indian companies emerged as important players in China's commercial transport, cement, and information technology sectors, Chinese companies acquired significant market shares in India's power, telecom, and construction equipment sectors. During this period, India also became "the largest destination for China's project exports," especially in the infrastructure sector, with an estimated US$55 billion worth of projects under execution in 2012.[85]

At the same time, India and China also began to cooperate on regional and global economic and political issues. Their common status as developing countries led them to adopt similar positions in the Doha Development Round, climate change negotiations, quota reforms in the International Monetary Fund, and tackling the global financial crisis.[86] Cooperation on these issues was reinforced by common membership in new multilateral groupings such as the Russia–India–China (RIC) forum, the Brazil–Russia–India–China–South Africa (BRICS) grouping of rising economies, and the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) – all of which ultimately seek the establishment of a multipolar order with a greater voice for non-Western countries on regional and global issues.[87] Ultimately, the entire edifice of India–China cooperation rested upon the declarations of a strategic and cooperative partnership in 2005 and a developmental partnership in 2014 based on "mutual respect and sensitivity for each other's concerns and aspirations."[88]

## *Persistence of Indian threat perception*